

PART 1

PITCH GUIDE DOCUMENT



THIS IS A GUIDE, NOT A TEMPLATE

- This document is here to **help you develop your idea — not to constrain it.**
- You don't need to follow the exact **structure, order, or content** of these slides. Every pitch will be different, and we understand that some points may not apply or may be difficult to answer in detail.
- Use these pages as **key elements to consider** and explain them with the level of detail and style that best fits your idea.
- **The goal is simple: everyone should understand your concept and envision it the same way.**
- **Use the following slides as guidance, not as a checklist.**

GENERAL GUIDELINES

When developing your pitch, consider the following:

01 BRAND DIRECTION

Is this linked to a Creative House brand, a Creative Network brand, or a new brand?

02 UBISOFT EDGE

Why should Ubisoft make this game, and what advantage do we have?

03 REUSE POTENTIAL

Can we reuse existing tools, knowledge, tech, pipelines, assets, or expertise?

04 AI OPPORTUNITY

Can AI help accelerate prototyping, iteration, content creation, or production?

05 SCALABLE AMBITION

Can the project start small and ramp up to a moderate size team, rather than requiring a 300+ person one?

06 MARKET OPPORTUNITY

What opportunity are you seeing between the idea, the market, the tech, Ubisoft's edge, and Shanghai's know-how?



CORE CONCEPT

Explain your game

What to include:

- Genre
- Player fantasy
- Unique selling point (USP)

Your content:

- Write 1-2 sentences max for your concept (your "elevator pitch")
- 1 short unique selling-point sentence

Example:

• Concept: "For me, action game will be a good opportunity to show strength when players are competing to receive high-risk cards."

USP: "The game combines high-pressure action gameplay with a visually striking Chinese mystery, implemented into a vertical under-water setting card."

Tip:

- If someone doesn't understand your idea in 10 seconds, simplify it
- Don't overuse 1 metaphor (e.g. this game is like [Game A] meets [Game B])
- The USP should answer "Why should we care?"

CORE GAMEPLAY LOOP

Explain how your game plays moment to moment

What to include:

- Core player actions
- Main gameplay loop
- What makes it fun

Your content:

- Bullet points, loop diagrams, images, etc.

Example:

• Taskline: Find target → Attack / Fight enemies → Sub and loot → Upgrade gear → Repeat

Tip:

- Focus on what the player does, not the world or story
- Keep it readable in a glance

CORE "TOY" / UNIQUE MECHANIC

What makes your game original and exciting

What to include:

- The key mechanic / system
- Why it stands out from other games

Your content:

- Bullet points, images, etc.

Example:

• Dynamic water currents that manage level navigation in real time- Players must adapt mechanical use
- Creates emergent risk/reward decisions every session

Tip:

- Focus on the what the player does, not the world or story
- Keep it readable in a glance

WORLD, STRUCTURE & NARRATIVE

Help us understand what kind of experience this game delivers

What to include:

- World structure
- Type of world (open world, linear, 2D/3D, etc.)
- How players navigate it (free roaming, mission-based, etc.)
- Core experience structure
- Narrative focus
- Narrative importance (light / medium / heavy)
- Tone / atmosphere
- Narrative delivery (dialogue, cinematic, environmental, etc.)

Your content:

- Bullet points, images, etc.

Example:

• Describe world with a one-sentence mission-based story- Players navigate through 3D open world with a story-driven experience
- Mission-driven narrative with optional story elements
- Tone: grounded, realistic, atmospheric, and dark
- Narrative delivery through environmental storytelling + light dialogue

Tip:

- Think about setting expectations, not writing a book: "What will it feel like to play this game?"
- Avoid overbuilding details
- Story summary

EXPERIENCE & PROGRESSION

Why players keep playing

What to include:

- Short-term goals (per session)
- Long-term progression (overall evolution)
- Variety / replayability

Your content:

- Bullet points, diagrams, etc.

Example:

• Clear, short-term goals (per session)- Long-term progression (overall evolution)
- Variety / replayability
- Different levels of difficulty

Tip:

- Focus on the player's experience
- Focus on the player's experience

AUDIENCE & MARKET FIT

Who is this game for, and why will it work

What to include:

- Target audience (core description)
- 2-3 comparable games
- Market opportunity (gap or repeat)

Your content:

- Bullet points, quotes, stats, etc.

Example:

• Target: mid-core players who enjoy role-playing and action games- Comparable games: League of Legends, Dota 2, and Star Wars
- Gap: accessible and hybrid action experience
- Strong potential for social play and replayability

Tip:

- Keep this simple — no need for player persona maps
- Show you understand the market and its players

CHINA / UBIISOFT SHA FIT

Why this game makes sense for China and this studio

What to include:

- Relevance for Chinese players / market
- Cultural / thematic resonance (if any)
- Why Ubisoft Shanghai can deliver it

Your content:

- Bullet points

Example:

• Strong appeal of sci-fi games in China- Strong appeal of sci-fi games in China
- Ubisoft Shanghai's expertise in sci-fi games
- Opportunity to position as a global hit

Tip:

- This is your elevator pitch, be explicit
- Avoid generic statements ("China is a big market")

PLATFORM & BUSINESS MODEL

Why this game makes sense for China and this studio

What to include:

- Platform(s)
- Business model (single buy)
- Why it fits the game

Your content:

- Bullet points

Example:

• PC + Console- Premium, seasonal updates
- Free-to-play model (optional)

Tip:

- Be clear on monetization
- Keep it brief and simple

WHY THIS GAME SHOULD EXIST

Convince us this idea is worth pursuing

What to include:

- Why now
- Why it matters
- Why it's a unique opportunity

Your content:

- Bullet points, images, stats, etc.

Example:

• Growing demand for sci-fi-themed games- Ubisoft Shanghai's expertise in sci-fi games
- Strong potential for innovative emergent moments
- Clear fit for Ubisoft's systemic design strengths

Tip:

- This is your "elevator pitch"
- Be direct and concise



CORE CONCEPT

01

Explain your game

What to include:

- Genre
- Player fantasy
- Unique selling point (USP)

Your content:

- Write 1–2 sentences max for your concept (your “one line pitch”)
- 1 short unique selling point sentence

Example:

- Concept: “Co-op extraction game set in a post-apocalyptic flooded Shanghai where players are competing to recover high-risk cargo.”

USP: “The game combines high-pressure extraction gameplay with a visually striking Chinese megacity transformed into a vertical underwater underground”

Tips:

- If someone doesn’t understand your idea in 10 seconds, simplify it
- Use references if helpful (e.g. My game is like [Game A] meets [Game B])
- The USP should answer: “Why should we care?”



CORE GAMEPLAY LOOP

02

Explain how your game plays moment to moment

What to include:

- Core player actions
- Main gameplay loop
- What makes it fun

Your content:

- Bullet points, loop diagram, images, etc.

Example:

- Explore → Find target → Avoid / fight threats → Extract loot → Upgrade gear → Repeat

Tips:

- Focus on the what the player does, not the world or story
- Keep it readable at a glance



CORE “TOY” / UNIQUE MECHANIC

03

What makes your game original and exciting

What to include:

- The key mechanic/ system
- Why it stands out from other games

Your content:

- Bullet points, images, etc.

Example:

- Dynamic water currents that reshape level navigation in real time
- Players must adapt routes mid-run
- Creates emergent risk/reward decisions every session

Tips:

- Focus on the what the player does, not the world or story
- Keep it readable at a glance



WORLD, STRUCTURE & NARRATIVE

04

Help us understand what kind of experience this game delivers

What to include:

- World & Structure
- Type of world (open world, linear, hub-based, etc.)
- How players navigate it (free roaming, mission-based, etc.)
- Overall experience structure
- Narrative & Tone
- Narrative importance (light / medium / heavy)
- Tone / atmosphere
- Narrative delivery (dialogue, cinematics, environmental, etc.)

Your content:

- Bullet points, images, etc.

Example:

- Semi-open world with a central hub and mission-based zones
- Players alternate between HQ preparation and outdoor expeditions
- Moderate narrative presence with optional story discovery
- Tone: grounded sci-fi with melancholic undertones
- Narrative delivered through environmental storytelling + light dialogue

Tips:

- You are setting expectations, not writing lore Think: "What will it feel like to play this game?"
- Avoid: Worldbuilding details
- Story summaries



EXPERIENCE & PROGRESSION

05

Why players keep playing

What to include:

- Short term goals (per session)
- Long-term progression (what evolves)
- Variety/ re-playability

Your content:

- Bullet points, diagrams, etc.

Example:

- Short term: complete risky delivery runs
- Long term: unlock new tools and deeper zones
- Increasing challenge and rewards
- Different routes and strategies per run

Tips:

- No need for a full system breakdown
- Focus on motivation to play again



AUDIENCE & MARKET FIT

06

Who is this game for, and why will it work

What to include:

- Target audience (broad description)
- 2–3 comparable games
- Market opportunity (gap or appeal)

Your content:

- Bullet points, quotes, stats, etc.

Example:

- Target: mid-core players who enjoy co-op and extraction games
- Comparable games: Escape from Tarkov, Dark and Darker
- Gap: accessible and stylized extraction experience
- Strong potential for social play and re-playability

Tips:

- Keep this simple — no deep player personas study
- Show you understand the market at a high level



CHINA / UBISOFT SHA FIT

07

Why this game makes sense for China and this studio

What to include:

- Relevance for Chinese players / market
- Cultural / thematic resonance (if any)
- Why Ubisoft Shanghai can deliver it

Your content:

- Bullet points

Example:

- Strong appeal of co-op games in China
- Shanghai setting creates immediate local relevance
- Fits Ubisoft's expertise in systemic open experiences
- Opportunity to position as a local yet global IP

Tips:

- This is a key evaluation point, be explicit
- Avoid generic statements ("China is a big market")



PLATFORM & BUSINESS MODEL

08

Why this game makes sense for China and this studio

What to include:

- Platform(s)
- Business model (high level)
- Why it fits the game

Your content:

- Bullet points

Example:

- PC + Console
- Premium + optional live updates
- Fits session-based gameplay and re-playability

Tips:

- No detailed monetization
- Keep it factual and simple



WHY THIS GAME SHOULD EXIST

09

Convince us this idea is worth pursuing

What to include:

- Why now
- Why it matters
- Why it's a strong opportunity

Your content:

- Bullet points, images, stats, etc.

Example:

- Growing demand for co-op shared experiences
- Extraction gameplay is popular but still evolving
- Strong potential for memorable emergent moments
- Clear fit for Ubisoft's systemic design strengths

Tips:

- This is your "closing argument"
- Be direct and confident



FINAL CHECK BEFORE SUBMITTING

10

Ask yourself:



Is my idea clear in < 30 seconds?



Is the core gameplay easy to understand?



Is the “toy” compelling and unique?



Is the pitch easy to read (not too long)?



Did I explain why this works for China / SHA?



EXAMPLE: BLACK MYTH WUKONG



BLACK MYTH
WUKONG

BLACK MYTH: CORE CONCEPT

WUKONG

CONCEPT

Black Myth: Wukong is a combat-driven single-player action RPG rooted in Chinese mythology, where players take the role of the Destined One and fight through a dark, spectacular reinterpretation of Journey to the West.

UNIQUE SELLING POINT

A high-production action RPG that turns one of China's most iconic mythological figures and worlds into a globally appealing premium console/PC experience, combining spectacular boss fights, fluid staff combat, mythological transformations, and AAA visual ambition.

USEFUL REFERENCES

Comparable gameplay territory: demanding third-person action RPGs with boss-focused progression.

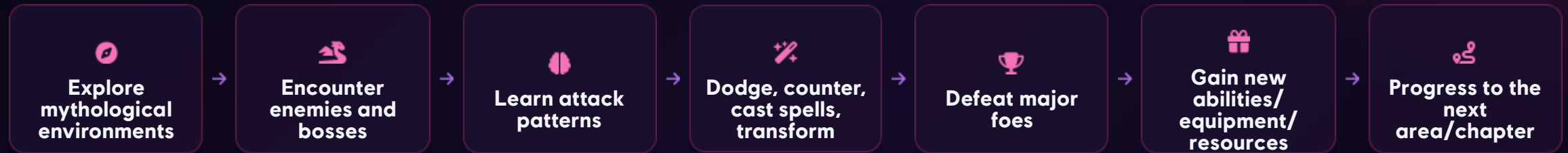
Comparable market positioning: premium single-player action RPG for PC and console players.

Key differentiator: Chinese mythology is not used as surface decoration; it is the foundation of the fantasy, enemies, world, tone, and visual identity.



BLACK MYTH: GAMEPLAY LOOP

WUKONG



CORE ACTIONS

- ♦ Move through linear or semi-linear mythological locations.
- ♦ Fight enemies using staff-based melee combat.
- ♦ Dodge, time attacks, manage stamina/resources, and exploit openings.
- ♦ Use spells, transformations, and equipment combinations to adapt combat style.
- ♦ Defeat powerful bosses that act as major progression and spectacle moments.

WHAT MAKES IT FUN

Combat is based on mastery: reading enemies, dodging at the right time, and finding attack openings. The player's toolbox expands through staff techniques, spells, transformations, and equipment. Bosses create memorable skill tests where players must adapt rather than simply repeat the same tactic. The fantasy of becoming a mythic warrior is expressed directly through combat, not mainly through dialogue or quest choices.



CORE “TOY” / KEY GAMEPLAY HOOK

WUKONG

Core Toy

Mythical martial staff combat supported by spells, transformations, and spectacular boss encounters.

Core Player Actions

- ◆ The staff gives the player a clear combat identity.
- ◆ The player is not just using generic melee attacks; the entire combat fantasy is built around mastering a mythic weapon.
- ◆ Spells and transformations expand the combat fantasy.
- ◆ They make the player feel like a supernatural mythological warrior, not just a skilled fighter.
- ◆ Boss fights are the main showcase of the game.
- ◆ They deliver challenge, spectacle, memorable enemy designs, and clear moments of mastery.
- ◆ The game makes Chinese mythology playable through action.
- ◆ The fantasy is expressed through movement, combat, enemies, powers, and boss encounters — not only through story or visual decoration.



WORLD, STRUCTURE & NARRATIVE

WUKONG

Black Myth: Wukong is structured as a guided, chapter-based action RPG journey through dark mythological locations. It is not a full open world; the experience is built around curated exploration, demanding combat encounters, spectacular bosses, and a mysterious reinterpretation of Journey to the West.

World & Structure

- ◆ Guided chapter-based progression
- ◆ Curated paths and handcrafted encounters
- ◆ Checkpoint rhythm for exploration, combat, recovery, and retry
- ◆ Focus on bosses and combat set pieces rather than free roaming

Narrative & Tone

- ◆ Medium-to-high narrative presence
- ◆ Dark, epic, mysterious mythological fantasy
- ◆ Story delivered through cinematics, characters, environment, and enemy backstories
- ◆ The fantasy is mainly experienced through action, not dialogue-heavy questing



Short-Term Player Goals

- ◆ Survive each combat encounter.
- ◆ Learn enemy and boss patterns.
- ◆ Improve timing, dodging, spell use, and attack decisions.
- ◆ Reach the next checkpoint, area, or major boss.

Long-Term Player Goals

- ◆ Progress through the mythological journey.
- ◆ Unlock and improve combat options.
- ◆ Discover new enemies, landscapes, and mythological characters.
- ◆ Build mastery over increasingly demanding fights.

Variety/ Re-playability Drivers

- ◆ Different bosses and enemy behaviors.
- ◆ Spell, ability, weapon, and equipment combinations.
- ◆ Transformations that change how the player approaches combat.
- ◆ Hidden discoveries, optional encounters, and mastery-driven challenge. Public descriptions mention combining spells, abilities, weapons, and equipment to find a strategy matching the player's combat style.



Target Audience

- ◆ Players who enjoy premium single-player action RPGs.
- ◆ Players attracted to demanding combat, boss fights, and mastery-based progression.
- ◆ Players interested in Chinese mythology, fantasy, and high-end visual production.
- ◆ PC and console audiences looking for a polished AAA-style experience from a Chinese studio.

Comparable Games/ Market Territory

- ◆ Demanding action RPGs and boss-focused games.
- ◆ Mythological action adventures.
- ◆ Premium PC/console single-player experiences..

Market Opportunity

- ◆ Premium action RPGs have a clear global audience.
- ◆ Chinese mythology offers a distinctive fantasy rarely explored at this production level.
- ◆ The game combines familiar action RPG appeal with a culturally specific world, enemies, powers, and tone.
- ◆ Positioning: globally understandable combat, China-rooted fantasy.



China Relevance

Black Myth: Wukong is deeply rooted in *Journey to the West*, one of China's Four Great Classical Novels, and uses Chinese mythology as its core creative foundation.

Why Ubi SHA Can Deliver it?

Not applicable in that case



PLATFORM & BUSINESS MODEL

WUKONG

Platforms

PC, PlayStation 5, and Xbox Series X/S

Business Model

Premium single-player game

Why It Fits

The game delivers value through a crafted solo journey, combat mastery, spectacular bosses, high-end presentation, and a complete mythological action RPG experience.



WHY THIS GAME SHOULD EXIST

WUKONG

Why Now

There is strong global interest in premium action RPGs, and Chinese-developed games have growing international visibility.

Why It Matters

Black Myth: Wukong demonstrates that a game can be both culturally specific and globally legible. It uses a famous Chinese mythological foundation while delivering an action RPG experience that international players can immediately understand

Why Is It a Strong Opportunity

- ◆ **Strong fantasy:** become a mythic warrior inspired by Sun Wukong.
- ◆ **Clear gameplay promise:** combat mastery, bosses, spells, and transformations.
- ◆ **Distinct identity:** Chinese mythology shapes the world, enemies, powers, and tone.
- ◆ **Global readability:** the action RPG structure is easy to understand internationally.
- ◆ **Premium fit:** a complete PC/console experience built around spectacle, mastery, and atmosphere.

